PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (Error! Hyperlink reference not valid.) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	SLEEP, BIOLOGICAL RHYTHMS, AND ANXIETY IN THE PERINATAL PERIOD: A SYSTEMATIC REVIEW PROTOCOL
AUTHORS	Cunningham, Jasmyn; Qureshi, Aljeena; Green, Sheryl; Frey, Benicio; Slyepchenko, Anastasiya

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Adam, Ishag University of Khartoum, Faculty of Medicine
REVIEW RETURNED	22-Dec-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	I expect to have high heterogeneity I suggest to mention that authors will use random model. The subgroups and meta-regression will be performed I suggest to mention these in details.

REVIEWER	Kang, Augustine Brown University School of Public Health
REVIEW RETURNED	16-Feb-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for the opportunity to review the manuscript. Overall the paper is well-written. I have just a few comments for the authors: Major-1) Depression and anxiety are comorbid conditions. A quick glance at recent literature indicates that it is over 60% comorbid (e.g. Groen et al., 2020). The authors must make it clear as to what the contributions are to the literature when anxiety is studied on its own, in the rationale subsection. Major-2) Section 2.1: Why include PTSD and OCD? They are not discussed in the intro and unlike what was described in line 17 on page 6, they are listed in the DSM 5. My takeaway from reading the introduction section was that the review will focus on perinatal anxiety - PTSD and OCD are relatively distinct, more chronic experiences. Kindly address this point. Minor-1) Emerging findings demonstrate the importance of the role of fathers in the parenthood experience for mothers, and how it impacts the very factors (sleep and anxiety) that the authors have included in their review. A potential way that the authors could integrate this in their methods would be to, in section 2.3, extract information on whether they had spousal/partner/familial support during the perinatal period.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1
Dr. Ishag Adam, University of Khartoum

Author response: Thank you for the suggestions, we have incorporated these details into our methods section (2.4 Data Synthesis and Evaluation, Page 7).

Reviewer: 2
Dr. Augustine Kang, Brown University School of Public Health

Major-1) Depression and anxiety are comorbid conditions. A quick glance at recent literature indicates that it is over 60% comorbid (e.g. Groen et al., 2020). The authors must make it clear as to what the contributions are to the literature when anxiety is studied on its own, in the rationale subsection.

Author response: Thank you for the suggestion. We have updated our rationale section to better elucidate the importance of studying anxiety outside of the context of depression (Page 4).

Major-2) Section 2.1: Why include PTSD and OCD? They are not discussed in the intro and unlike what was described in line 17 on page 6, they are listed in the DSM 5. My takeaway from reading the introduction section was that the review will focus on perinatal anxiety - PTSD and OCD are relatively distinct, more chronic experiences. Kindly address this point.

Author response: Thank you for your suggestion. We have updated our introduction to explain our reasoning for including PTSD and OCD as part of this review (1.1 Rationale, Pages 4 and 5). To accommodate this, we have broadened the scope of the review to include “anxiety and related disorders” (1.2 Objectives, Page 5).

Minor-1) Emerging findings demonstrate the importance of the role of fathers in the parenthood experience for mothers, and how it impacts the very factors (sleep and anxiety) that the authors have included in their review. A potential way that the authors could integrate this in their methods would be to, in section 2.3, extract information on whether they had spousal/partner/familial support during the perinatal period.

Author response: We appreciate the suggestion and agree this would be an interesting variable to include. We have updated our methods section (2.3 Screening and Data Extraction, Page 6) to also extract this information.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Kang, Augustine Brown University School of Public Health
REVIEW RETURNED	08-May-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	No further comments